

## Week 4 Enabling Activities

### Hypothetical & Conditional

This set covers the full six-activity family for Hypothetical & Conditional, organized as two tracks: 1a--1c build the Condition → Projected Outcome → Extended Scenario move in stages; 4a--4c test whether it has proceduralized. These supplement -- they do not replace -- this week's folder and the ESO/Frames Daily Protocol.

#### This Week's Frame — Hypothetical & Conditional (W4)

##### Condition

What must hold for this scenario to follow?

##### Projected Outcome

What would likely result?

##### Extended Scenario

And if that outcome holds, then what?

**Key requirement:** the extended scenario must go one step beyond the projected outcome. A response that states the condition and the immediate result but stops there is only two-thirds of the move.

#### Activity Index

1a. Single-Scenario Depth Ladder · 1b. Sentence-Frame Progression · 1c. 3-Interval Comparison & Paraphrase · 4a. 2-Box Induction · 4b. Silent Protocol & Brief-Back · 4c. Strategic Competence & Fallback

## Single-Scenario Depth Ladder — "Scaffold the Scaffold"

*Holds one low-stakes scenario constant while building the Condition → Projected Outcome → Extended Scenario move in four steps. Use before a student's first W4 attempt, or as remediation if responses stop at the first outcome.*

### ANCHOR SCENARIO (HELD CONSTANT ACROSS ALL FOUR ITEMS)

A country lowers its voting age to 16.

1

#### Surface

*"If a country lowers its voting age to 16, what is the condition, exactly?"*

State the condition precisely — what has to actually be true.

2

#### Surface → Deep

*"What would likely result immediately from that condition?"*

Add the Projected Outcome box. First-order result only — stop here for now.

3

#### Deep

*"If the voting age drops to 16, more young people would likely vote in that first election. And if that higher turnout holds over several elections, then \_\_\_\_."*

Complete the Extended Scenario — the second-order consequence, one step further than the first outcome.

4

#### Transfer

*"What would happen if countries made voting mandatory for all adults?"*

Full response: condition + projected outcome + extended scenario, no connector given.

**Instructor note:** 5--10 minute warm-up. A student who completes Item 4 without hesitation is ready for the Week 4 folder.

## Causal Subordination → Concessive Subordination → Relative Clause & Appositive

*Builds subordinate-clause complexity in three tiers using connectors that read as ILR 2+/3, not just connectors that are technically subordinating. Coordinating conjunctions (FANBOYS) are excluded -- and so are 'because' and 'so': both are grammatically fine, but they're exactly the safe, overused connectors that inflate a proficiency ceiling. T1 uses higher-register causal subordinators with more precision.*

### SCENARIO

A country lowers its voting age to 16.

T1

#### Causal subordination — given that / on the grounds that / considering that

Complete each sentence, naming one condition-to-outcome link.

- "Turnout among young voters would likely rise given that \_\_\_\_."
- "Election officials are willing to lower the voting age on the grounds that \_\_\_\_."
- "Some critics remain skeptical of the change considering that \_\_\_\_."

T2

#### Concessive subordination — although / while / even though

Hold the immediate outcome and the extended scenario in tension inside one sentence.

- "While younger voters might turn out modestly in the first election, the long-term effect \_\_\_\_."
- "Although the immediate outcome seems small, the extended scenario \_\_\_\_."
- "Even though critics doubt any short-term impact, sustained turnout over several elections \_\_\_\_."

T3a

#### Restrictive relative clauses — "Fact who \_\_\_\_, Fact"

Complete each sentence with a relative clause. Then combine them into one sentence using a subordinating conjunction of your choice.

- "Young voters who \_\_\_\_ tend to develop lasting civic habits."
- "Campaign strategists who \_\_\_\_ begin targeting younger demographics earlier."

T3b

#### Appositives — "Fact, \_\_\_\_, Fact"

Compress the stakeholder's identity into a noun phrase and embed it as a non-restrictive appositive.

#### MODEL

"The lowered voting age, the initial condition that opens the door to younger participation, produces a modest bump in first-time turnout, while the extended pattern of civic habit-forming, compounding across several election cycles, eventually reshapes which issues campaigns prioritize."

**Instructor note:** 'because' and 'so' aren't FANBOYS, but they're the safe, overused connectors that flag a proficiency ceiling. T1 swaps them for 'given that' / 'on the grounds that' / 'considering that' -- same causal entry point, higher register from the first sentence. Move to T2 only once T1 is fluent. T3a is the entry point — relative clauses are the simpler move. T3b compresses a full clause into a noun phrase — more demanding. Move to T3b only once T3a is fluent. Both are stretch — optional for students still consolidating T1 and T2.

## Comparison & Paraphrase Prompts

Connects conditional-projection vocabulary to comparative sentence structures, moving from a simple one-line comparison to a claim that explicitly extends one step past the first outcome.

### COMPARISON PAIR

How the voting age policy's first-election outcome compares with its extended effect across several election cycles.

Target Lexicon — must appear at least once

contingent  
on

were  
[X] to  
occur

in turn

absent  
[X]

downstream

1

#### Surface

"In one sentence, compare the immediate outcome of lowering the voting age with its extended effect over several elections."

2

#### Deep

"Using contingent on, explain what the extended scenario depends on beyond the first election's turnout."

3

#### Transfer

"Write one complex sentence connecting the projected outcome to the extended scenario, using in turn or downstream."

**Instructor note:** score for lexicon use and whether the extended scenario genuinely goes one step beyond the first outcome — not for stance on lowering the voting age.

## Visual Synthesis

*Forces students to notice when a conditional claim's condition has gone unstated from grouped, unlabeled examples — no rule is stated up front.*

### Box A

- If the city extends the subway line into the suburbs, downtown traffic would likely ease during rush hour.
- If schools eliminate standardized testing, teachers would likely have more flexibility in lesson planning.
- If the company adopts a four-day week, employee retention would likely improve.

### Box B

- Downtown traffic would likely ease during rush hour.
- Teachers would likely have more flexibility in lesson planning.
- Employee retention would likely improve.

### TASK

Box B's claims could just as easily be simple predictions about the future — nothing marks them as conditional reasoning. What is missing from Box B that Box A has? Why does naming the condition explicitly matter for this week's frame?

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**Instructor note:** this is a common failure mode at ILR 2+: students describe a plausible future without ever grounding it in the 'if' that makes it conditional reasoning rather than a guess. Let the student name what's missing before you confirm it.

## Silent Modeling & Pre-Attempt Brief-Back

*Separates rule comprehension from production. Students extract the frame's structure from a marked-but-unexplained model, then must plan out loud before they're allowed to attempt their own response.*

### PHASE 1 — SILENT MODELING

Read the response below. Three elements are marked [A], [B], [C]. No explanation is given — identify what each represents before moving to Phase 2.

[A] If the country lowers its voting age to sixteen — a change that would immediately add several million newly eligible voters to the rolls before the next election — [B] turnout among that age group would likely be modest at first, since first-time voters historically participate at lower rates than experienced ones regardless of age. [C] But if those sixteen-year-olds vote even once before adulthood, research on civic habit-forming suggests they become measurably more likely to vote for the rest of their lives — meaning the policy's real effect wouldn't show up in the first election at all, but in the turnout data twenty years later.

**Key (reveal only after Phase 2).** In the digital version, each move is color-highlighted. In print, use letter markers above.



[A] =  
Condition



[B] =  
Projected  
Outcome



[C] =  
Extended  
Scenario

### PHASE 2 — VERBAL BRIEF-BACK ("PLAN BEFORE YOU PRODUCE")

Before attempting your own response to the prompt below, say out loud -- or write in one sentence -- your plan for each of the frame's three moves. Do not begin your full response until you've stated your plan.

### PROMPT FOR PHASE 2 ATTEMPT

"What would happen if the voting age were lowered to sixteen only for local city elections, not national ones?"

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**Instructor note:** the brief-back is a planning checkpoint, not a rehearsal -- keep it to one sentence. This models a legitimate strategy: a brief pause to organize before speaking.

## Fallback Scaffolding

Tests whether the frame's core move survives without its own vocabulary -- the ILR 3 skill of knowing what to do when the exact word isn't available.

### CONSTRAINT

Restate the argument below without using the bolded words. Add hedging language as you restate.

#### Argument to Restate

If the voting age drops to sixteen, the **condition** is met for a new cohort of first-time voters to participate before adulthood. The **projected outcome** is modest initial turnout — first-time voters historically participate at lower rates. But the **extended scenario** is more significant: young people who vote once are measurably more likely to vote for the rest of their lives.

### PROMPT

"What would happen if countries made voting mandatory for all adults?"

### Fallback Strategies to Practice

a

#### Circumlocution

Instead of "condition," try "what has to be true first" or "the starting point."

b

#### Term substitution

Instead of "projected outcome" / "extended scenario," try "what happens right away" / "what happens after that, over time."

c

#### Self-correction

"What I mean is..." / "Let me put that another way..."

d

#### Hedging

"It seems likely that..." / "This could eventually lead to..."

**Instructor note:** use after a student is reliably producing the frame vocabulary. The argument frame provides the content — the task is circumlocution plus hedging, not generation from scratch. This is a stress test, not a first attempt.